

Science Corps Fellowship Application

Thank you for your interest in becoming a Science Corps Fellow. Please complete all required fields. We review applications on a rolling basis.

First Name *

Emily

Last Name *

O'Rourke

Email *

emily.orourke@pennmedicine.upenn.edu

Gender



Male



Female



Non-Binary

Residence: City (State), Country *

Philadelphia, PA

Nationality *

United States

When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD? (month and year) *

April/May 2027

Please indicate the university where you earned (or are currently pursuing) your PhD *

University of Pennsylvania

Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow? *

Science is creative and shaped by our social and cultural experiences. I believe it is strengthened by diversity, equity, and inclusion. My path to science began with early experiences that sparked my curiosity and convinced me that a career in research was possible.

I feel deeply aligned with the mission of Science Corps. I want to use the scientific and teaching skills I gained during my Ph.D. to help make STEM education more accessible while learning from students and teachers at CVIF in the Philippines. I have learned that listening and adaptability are essential to good science education.

My commitment to equity in STEM is deeply personal. Inspired by my parents' love of science and belief in the transformative power of education, I hope to empower students to pursue STEM careers while growing as a scientist, teacher, and globally conscious educator.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science *
Corps Fellow.

I have intentionally found opportunities to teach, mentor, and design educational materials throughout college and graduate school. These experiences have prepared me to design high quality STEM teaching materials, adapt my teaching to diverse students, and uniquely contribute as a Science Corps Fellow. At MIT, I participated in the Global Teaching Labs program in Haifa, Israel, where I designed and taught a week-long STEM workshop for middle school students in English-, Arabic-, and Hebrew-speaking public schools. Teaching across language and cultural differences strengthened my passion for science education. At the University of Pennsylvania, I have taught STEM workshops for elementary students, mentored high school, undergraduate, and graduate students, and designed and taught a Spanish conversation course for five semesters. Together, these experiences strengthened my belief that mentorship and engaging teaching can inspire scientific curiosity and confidence.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply. *

- ☒ Scientist in academia
- ☐ Doing science in industry
- ☐ Administrative role in industry or academia
- ☒ In science education
- ☒ In science outreach
- ☐ Other:

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally *
in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

In the near term, I plan to complete my Ph.D. in Cell and Molecular Biology at the University of Pennsylvania. My thesis work is about host-pathogen interactions during Salmonella infection. Before starting a postdoctoral fellowship, I hope to spend six months to a year pursuing an opportunity such as Science Corps. I want to step outside the traditional academic path and focus on global science education. This experience will broaden my perspective as a scientist and support my goal to help make STEM more accessible. After this experience, I plan to do a postdoctoral fellowship investigating basic biology questions in bacterial-host interactions and continue to teach and mentor students.

In the longer term, my goal is to lead an independent academic research laboratory studying the molecular mechanisms of host-pathogen interactions and teach at the university level. I hope to build a lab that is focused on rigorous science, curiosity, collaboration, and inclusion. I want to mentor trainees from diverse backgrounds and help them feel supported and empowered to succeed. I also aim to develop international collaborations that combine fundamental biological research with global impact. And lastly, I plan to contribute to or build programs that expand access to STEM education and promote equity in academia. Working as a Science Corps fellow will be an important step toward achieving these goals. This fellowship will help me better understand science education in a global context. I believe that it will also shape the way I mentor and lead a research lab throughout my career. Science Corps is aligned with my long-term goal to become an accomplished scientist and educator and help to make science more inclusive and globally connected.

How did you find out about Science Corps? *

- ☒ An email list in your institution
- ☐ A post on a job-site
- ☐ An entry in a post-doc search resource (e.g., ecoevjobs.net)
- ☐ Referred by a previous fellow
- ☐ Referred by a friend/colleague/supervisor in academia
- ☐ Other:

Upload your CV / resume *

.ORourke_CV_Jun...

⬆ Add file

This form was created inside of Science-corps.

Google Forms